

KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Yom Teruah

The Appointed Season No One Can Miss

A Midrash Study on the Day of Trumpets and the Return of Yahshua

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible with the sacred names restored. Torah is referred to throughout as the instructions of YHWH.

THE HEART OF IT

Yahshua said no one knows the day or the hour of his return. In the same discourse he said that those who watch the tree will know the season, and Paul said the day will not overtake the children of light like a thief. Both are true, and Yom Teruah is where they meet. It is the one appointed time YHWH placed on the first day of a month, the head of the month, and marked with a trumpet blast. A day you cannot pin down, inside a season you cannot miss if you are watching.

SECTION I

The Text

Only two passages in the instructions of YHWH command this day. Both are short. Both are loaded.

YHWH spoke to Moses, saying, Speak to the children of Israel, saying, In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, shall be a solemn rest to you, a memorial of blowing of trumpets, a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work; and you shall offer an offering made by fire to YHWH.

LEVITICUS 23:23-25

In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work. It is a day of blowing of trumpets to you.

NUMBERS 29:1

Now notice what is not there. There is no explanation. No historical event attached. No Passover lamb, no exodus, no wilderness booths. Every other appointed day in Leviticus 23 comes with a reason written into the text. This one comes with a sound and a silence.

That silence is not an oversight. It is the design of the day.

SECTION II

Moed: The Appointed Season

This is the foundation everything else rests on, so we build it slowly.

The word itself

The Hebrew word is **moed**, plural **moedim**. It does not mean holiday, and it does not mean festival in the way we use that word. It means an appointed time, a fixed season, a set meeting. It carries the sense of a rendezvous, a scheduled appearance, a meeting placed on the calendar by someone with the authority to place it there.

Elohim said, Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs to mark seasons, days, and years.

GENESIS 1:14

That word *seasons* is *moedim*. On day four of creation, before there was a Hebrew, before there was an Israel, before there was a scroll of instructions, YHWH hung the sun and the moon in the sky and said they exist to mark his appointments.

The appointed times are not Jewish culture. They are written into the sky.

He appointed the moon for seasons. The sun knows when to set.

PSALM 104:19

Whose feasts are they

YHWH spoke to Moses, saying, Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, The set feasts of YHWH, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts.

LEVITICUS 23:1-2

Read that last line again. *My set feasts*. He does not call them the feasts of Israel. He does not call them the feasts of the Jews. He signs his own name to them. They belong to YHWH. Israel was simply the household that was handed the calendar to keep.

These are the set feasts of YHWH, even holy convocations, which you shall proclaim in their appointed season.

LEVITICUS 23:4

In their appointed season. Not whenever it is convenient. Not on a date a council picked centuries later. In the season he set.

A WORD ABOUT HOLY CONVOCATION

The phrase is **miqra qodesh**. *Miqra* comes from the root **qara**, to call, to proclaim, to summon, to read. It means a sacred assembly, a called gathering, a day his people are summoned to.

It is worth saying plainly that it does not mean *rehearsal*. That is a popular teaching and it is not what the word carries. The prophetic weight of these days is real, but it comes from the events Scripture records landing on them, not from a meaning pressed into a Hebrew noun.

SEASON, NOT DATE

Here is the key that unlocks the whole study. A moed is a season, and a season has an arrival you can feel before you can pinpoint it.

You do not need a calendar to know autumn is coming. The air changes. The light changes. The leaves turn.

You know the season long before you could name the exact hour it began. That is the entire prophetic logic of this day.

SECTION III**The Name and the Sound**

Yom Teruah means the Day of Blowing, or more literally the Day of Shouting. The Hebrew **teruah** is a specific kind of sound. Not a smooth note. A broken, urgent, staccato blast. An alarm. A war cry. A shout.

Scripture uses teruah for several things, and every one of them preaches.

Teruah as alarm and assembly

In Numbers 10:1-10 YHWH commands two silver trumpets. Read carefully what they are for:

- A long blast gathers the whole congregation to the door of the tent. Numbers 10:3
- A teruah, the broken alarm blast, breaks the camp and moves it out. Numbers 10:5-6
- A teruah in war means you will be remembered before YHWH your Elohim, and you will be saved from your enemies. Numbers 10:9
- And trumpets are blown in the day of your gladness, in your set feasts, and in the beginnings of your months. Numbers 10:10

Assembly. Movement. Remembrance. Deliverance. That is the vocabulary of the trumpet, and it is the vocabulary of the return of Yahshua.

Teruah as the sound that brings walls down

When they make a long blast with the ram's horn, and when you hear the sound of the trumpet, all the people shall shout with a great shout; and the wall of the city shall fall down flat.

JOSHUA 6:5

The trumpet and the shout together bring down what looked permanent (Joshua 6:20).

Teruah as the sound of joy

- When the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of Elohim shouted for joy. Job 38:7
- At the laying of the foundation, the shout of joy and the weeping of the old men mixed together until no one could tell the two apart. Ezra 3:11-13

Joy and grief in the same sound. That is what a trumpet does to a heart that has been waiting a very long time.

Teruah as the sound of the King arriving

Elohim has gone up with a shout, YHWH with the sound of a trumpet.

PSALM 47:5

Blessed are the people who know the joyful sound. They walk, YHWH, in the light of your face.

PSALM 89:15

That phrase, the joyful sound, is **teruah**. Blessed are the people who know the sound. Not the people who know the date. The people who recognize the sound when they hear it.

SECTION IV

Why It Is Called the Day No One Knows

What the text actually establishes

Every appointed time in Leviticus 23 is anchored to a numbered day of a month. Passover is the fourteenth. Unleavened Bread runs the fifteenth through the twenty first. Yom Kippur is the tenth. Sukkot is the fifteenth.

Yom Teruah is the only moed that falls on **the first day of a month**. Every other one is counted from a date already fixed inside a month that is already running. This one begins when the month begins.

And in Scripture the month is tied to the moon. The Hebrew word for month is **chodesh**, from the root **chadash**, to be new, to renew. Psalm 104:19 says he appointed the moon for the moedim, and the trumpets were sounded at the beginnings of the months (Numbers 10:10; Numbers 28:11). The moon marks the months. That much is plain.

Now the honest part, in three places

First, the mechanism. It is commonly taught, and this handout used to teach it, that the month cannot be declared until witnesses confirm a first visible crescent. There is no such commandment in Torah. No verse instructs anyone to go out, look for a sliver, and declare the month on the testimony of two men. Scripture ties the month to the moon and stops. Where it stops speaking, we stop calling our interpretation a commandment (Deuteronomy 4:2; 12:32).

Blow the trumpet at the New Moon, at the full moon, on our feast day.

PSALM 81:3

Second, this verse. It is often said that the Hebrew behind *New Moon* here carries the sense of concealment. It does not. That word is **chodesh**, from chadash, to renew. The concealment argument attaches to the second word in the verse, **keseh**, and keseh is the word most translations render as *full moon*. Its meaning is genuinely disputed. A verse that scholars cannot agree on is not a foundation. This handout no longer builds the hiddenness of the day on Psalm 81:3.

Third, 1 Samuel 20. This chapter gets claimed by both sides, and both sides have something in it. David says *tomorrow is the new moon* and Jonathan says it back to him (1 Samuel 20:5, 18), which shows they knew the day before it arrived. The observance also runs across two days (20:27), which shows some flexibility in how it was kept. Read the chapter and let it say what it says. It does not settle the calendar question, and we should not pretend it settles it for us.

WHAT SURVIVES, AND IT IS ENOUGH

Strip out everything Torah does not command and this is what is left standing, which is the part that mattered all along:

Yom Teruah is the only appointed time YHWH placed on the head of a month rather than inside one. Yahshua said the day and hour of his return is known to the Father alone (Matthew 24:36), and he said he returns at a trumpet, after the tribulation, to gather his own (Matthew 24:29-31). Those are his words, not a tradition, and the case does not need a mechanism propped under it.

And the tradition we do not need

You will hear it taught that *no man knows the day or hour* was a common Jewish idiom for this feast, and that everyone in the first century would have heard Yahshua say it and immediately thought of Yom Teruah.

Be straight with people about this. That specific idiom claim is not written in Scripture. It comes from later rabbinic and traditional sources. We do not build doctrine on rabbinic tradition, and we should not build it on our own favorite explanations either.

HOLD IT AT THE RIGHT WEIGHT

Scripture does not explicitly tie Matthew 24:36 to this feast. Treat the connection as a pattern worth weighing rather than a proof, and let the explicit passages carry the argument. That is not a retreat. It is the difference between a teaching that holds up under examination and one that collapses the first time somebody asks for chapter and verse.

SECTION V**The Words of Yahshua*****The statement***

But no one knows of that day and hour, not even the angels of heaven, but my Father only.

MATTHEW 24:36

But of that day or that hour no one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father. Watch, keep alert, and pray; for you do not know when the time is.

MARK 13:32-33

The parable that names the feast without naming it

Look at every element of Matthew 25:1-13, the ten virgins:

- A bridegroom whose arrival time is not announced.
- Ten who are waiting, all of whom believe they are ready.
- Lamps and oil, the difference between profession and preparation.
- A delay long enough that all ten fall asleep.

- A cry at midnight, a shout in the dark, waking everyone at once.
- A door that shuts.
- And the closing line: watch therefore, for you do not know the day nor the hour in which the Son of Man is coming. Matthew 25:13

A shout in the darkness that wakes the sleeping and separates the ready from the unready. That is a teruah.

The verse that changes everything

Right before Yahshua says no one knows the day, he says this:

Now from the fig tree learn this parable: When its branch has now become tender and produces its leaves, you know that the summer is near. Even so you also, when you see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors.

MATTHEW 24:32-33

See the fig tree and all the trees. When they are already budding, you see it and know by your own selves that the summer is already near. Even so you also, when you see these things happening, know that the Kingdom of Elohim is near.

LUKE 21:29-31

THE WHOLE TEACHING IN ONE LINE

You will not know the day. You will know the season.

He did not offer that as a suggestion. He said *you know*. He expects it. A man who watches the tree knows summer is coming, and he still cannot tell you the hour summer started.

Failing to know the season is a rebuke

When you see a cloud rising from the west, immediately you say, A shower is coming, and so it happens. When a south wind blows, you say, There will be a scorching heat, and it happens. You hypocrites! You know how to interpret the appearance of the earth and the sky, but how is it that you do not interpret this time?

LUKE 12:54-56

- You know how to discern the appearance of the sky, but you cannot discern the signs of the times. Matthew 16:2-3
- Because you did not know the time of your visitation. Luke 19:44

Jerusalem missed him. Not because the information was hidden, but because they were not watching the season. That warning lands on us too.

The clearest passage in Scripture on this

But concerning the times and the seasons, brothers, you have no need that anything be written to you. For you yourselves know well that the day of YHWH comes like a thief in the night... But you, brothers, are not in darkness, that the day should overtake you like a thief. You are all children of light and children of the day. We do not belong to the night, nor to darkness, so then let us not sleep, as the rest do, but let us watch and be sober.

1 THESSALONIANS 5:1-6

Sit with this one. Paul says the day comes like a thief, and then immediately says it will not come like a thief to you. Why? Because you are not in darkness. Because you are watching. Because you know the times and the seasons.

The Greek word there is **kairos**, appointed season, the same idea used to render moed in the Greek Scriptures. The children of light know the moedim. That is the difference between being caught and being ready.

If therefore you will not watch, I will come as a thief, and you will not know what hour I will come on you.

REVELATION 3:3

Read the condition. *If you will not watch.* The thief language is conditional, and the condition is watchfulness (see also Revelation 16:15).

Holding the tension honestly

It is not for you to know times or seasons which the Father has set within his own authority.

ACTS 1:7

Someone will bring this verse to you. Handle it plainly. The disciples were asking for a restoration schedule so they could sit down and calculate. Yahshua refused to feed date setting. He did not cancel watchfulness, because Matthew 24, Matthew 25, Mark 13, and 1 Thessalonians 5 all command it.

DRAW THE LINE HERE

Date setting is forbidden. Season watching is commanded.

Those are not the same activity, and confusing them has wrecked a lot of faith.

SECTION VI

The Trumpet and the Resurrection

This is where Yom Teruah stops being a nice pattern and becomes the literal mechanism of our hope.

Behold, I tell you a mystery. We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed.

1 CORINTHIANS 15:51-52

For the Master himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trumpet of Elohim. The dead in Messiah will rise first, then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Master in the air.

1 THESSALONIANS 4:16-17

Look at the components: a shout, a voice, a trumpet. That is a teruah with a resurrection attached to it.

But immediately after the oppression of those days... he will send out his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they will gather together his chosen ones from the four winds, from one end of the sky to the other.

MATTHEW 24:29-31

Note the timing marker Yahshua placed himself. *After the oppression of those days.* The gathering happens at the trumpet, after the tribulation, not before it. This is the resurrection of the dead and the changing of the living into glorified bodies.

The seventh angel sounded, and great voices in heaven followed, saying, The kingdom of the world has become the Kingdom of our Master, and of his Messiah. He will reign forever and ever!

REVELATION 11:15

The last trumpet. The seventh. The kingdom transfers at a trumpet blast.

The prophets said it first

It will happen in that day that a great trumpet will be blown; and those who were ready to perish in the land of Assyria, and those who were outcasts in the land of Egypt, shall come; and they will worship YHWH in the holy mountain at Jerusalem.

ISAIAH 27:13

Do not read past that one. The great trumpet gathers the ones scattered into Assyria. That is the northern house, the tribes who were exiled and lost their identity. The trumpet is the sound that brings the outcasts home and puts the two sticks back into one hand (Ezekiel 37:15-22).

Zechariah 9:14	The Master YHWH will blow the trumpet, and will go with whirlwinds of the south.
Joel 2:1	Blow the trumpet in Zion, and sound an alarm in my holy mountain, for the day of YHWH comes, for it is close at hand.
Joel 2:15	Blow the trumpet in Zion. Sanctify a fast. Call a solemn assembly.
Zephaniah 1:14-16	The great day of YHWH is near. A day of the trumpet and alarm against the fortified cities.
Amos 3:6	Does the trumpet alarm sound in a city without the people being afraid?
Hosea 5:8	Blow the horn in Gibeah, and the trumpet in Ramah.
Exodus 19:16-19	At Sinai the voice of the trumpet sounded loud and long, and grew louder and louder.

Every prophet who describes the Day of YHWH reaches for the same instrument.

SECTION VII

The Memorial and the Books

Leviticus 23:24 calls it a **zikhron teruah**, a memorial of blowing. Memorial means remembrance, and remembrance runs in both directions.

Then you shall sound an alarm with the trumpets. Then you will be remembered before YHWH your Elohim, and you will be saved from your enemies.

NUMBERS 10:9

The trumpet is the sound of being remembered by YHWH.

Then those who feared YHWH spoke one with another; and YHWH listened and heard, and a book of memory was written before him for those who feared YHWH and who honored his name... They shall be mine, says YHWH of Armies, my own possession in the day that I make.

MALACHI 3:16-18

There is a book with names in it, and there is a day when it is opened (Daniel 7:10; Revelation 20:12). The trumpet is the sound that announces the day has come.

SECTION VIII

The Pattern of the Feasts

Here is the argument that closes the case for anyone paying attention.

The spring feasts were fulfilled to the day

Passover	Yahshua died as the lamb, at Passover. For indeed Messiah, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place. 1 Corinthians 5:7
Unleavened Bread	His body in the tomb, without corruption, without leaven. Acts 2:27
Firstfruits	He rose as the firstfruits of those who are asleep. 1 Corinthians 15:20-23
Shavuot	The Spirit poured out when the day had fully come. Acts 2:1

Four appointments. Four fulfillments. Not one of them was approximate. Every single one landed on the exact appointed day.

So what does that tell you about the fall feasts

Three remain: Trumpets, Atonement, and Tabernacles. If he kept the first four appointments to the hour, he is not going to improvise the last three.

Let no one therefore judge you in eating or drinking, or with respect to a feast day or a new moon or a Sabbath day, which are a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Messiah's.

COLOSSIANS 2:16-17

Read it carefully, because this verse gets used backwards constantly. Paul does not say the appointed times are cancelled. He says do not let people judge you for keeping them, and then he says they are a shadow of things **to come**. Future tense, written decades after the resurrection. The shadow is still pointing at something. Whatever else anyone makes of the passage, Paul never writes that YHWH's Sabbath and appointed times have been abolished.

SECTION IX

Why Followers of Yahshua Should Keep This Day

Here is the case, laid out plainly, without arguing with anybody.

1. *He called them his.*

These are my set feasts (Leviticus 23:2). Not Jewish feasts. His. If they belong to him, and we belong to him, the question mostly answers itself.

2. *They were never given only to one bloodline.*

- One law shall be to him who is born at home, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you. Exodus 12:49
- One statute for you and for the foreigner, forever throughout your generations. Numbers 15:15-16
- Let no foreigner who has joined himself to YHWH say, YHWH will surely separate me from his people. Them I will bring to my holy mountain. Isaiah 56:3, 6-7

3. *You have already been brought near.*

You were at that time separate from Messiah, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of the promise... But now in Messiah Yahshua you who once were far off are made near in the blood of Messiah... So then you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but you are fellow citizens with the saints and of the household of Elohim.

EPHESIANS 2:11-13, 19

You were grafted into the olive tree (Romans 11:17-24). The tree did not become yours. You became part of it. A grafted branch does not get a different calendar than the tree.

4. *The first followers kept them.*

- They were gathered together on Shavuot when the Spirit fell. Acts 2:1
- Paul arranged his travel around keeping the appointed times. Acts 18:21; Acts 20:16
- Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old yeast, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth. 1 Corinthians 5:8

That last one was written to a mostly non-Jewish congregation in Greece. *Let us keep the feast.*

5. *Yahshua kept them, and we follow him.*

- He went up to the Feast of Tabernacles. John 7:2, 10
- I have earnestly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer. Luke 22:15

- He who says he remains in him ought himself also to walk just like he walked. 1 John 2:6
- If you love me, keep my commandments. John 14:15
- Do not think that I came to destroy the Torah or the prophets. I did not come to destroy, but to fulfill. Matthew 5:17-19

6. *They are still being kept in the age to come.*

- Everyone who is left of all the nations will go up from year to year to worship the King and to keep the feast of booths. Zechariah 14:16-19
- From one new moon to another, and from one Sabbath to another, all flesh will come to worship before me. Isaiah 66:22-23
- The appointed times observed in the restored kingdom. Ezekiel 45:21-25

If the nations keep them in the kingdom, there is no version of this where they were abolished in between.

7. *And the practical one.*

You cannot watch a clock you refuse to look at. He said watch. He tied his return to a trumpet. He put a trumpet on the calendar. Keeping this day is how you stay oriented to the season.

SECTION X

Not Ritual, Relationship

Now the guardrail, because this is where people get hurt. Keeping a feast does not save anybody. It never did.

Bring no more vain offerings. Incense is an abomination to me. New moons, Sabbaths, and convocations: I cannot stand evil assemblies. My soul hates your New Moons and your appointed feasts.

ISAIAH 1:13-14

Stop and feel that. He is not condemning the days he himself commanded. He is condemning days kept by hands full of blood and hearts full of pride. Read the next verses. He tells them to wash, to cease from evil, to relieve the oppressed, to plead for the widow.

- I hate, I despise your feasts... But let justice roll on like rivers, and righteousness like a mighty stream. Amos 5:21-24
- These people draw near to me with their mouth, and honor me with their lips; but their heart is far from me. Matthew 15:8-9
- What does YHWH require of you, but to act justly, to love mercy, and to walk humbly with your Elohim? Micah 6:8

SAY IT PLAINLY

Do not blow a shofar and then go back to holding a grudge. Do not put on tzitzit and refuse to forgive your brother. Do not learn a Hebrew word and stay proud. That is exactly what he said he hates. The day is an appointment with a Person. Keep the appointment, but bring your heart.

SECTION XI

The Trumpet, Forgiveness, and Freedom

This is the thread we never want to miss, because it is the reason this ministry exists. The trumpet in Scripture is not only a warning. It is the sound of release.

Then you shall sound the loud trumpet on the tenth day of the seventh month. On the Day of Atonement you shall sound the trumpet throughout all your land. You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you; and each of you shall return to his own property, and each of you shall return to his family.

LEVITICUS 25:8-10

Debts cancelled. Slaves released. Property restored. Families reunited. All of it announced by a horn.

And when Yahshua stood up in the synagogue to announce his own ministry, this is the passage he reached for:

The Spirit of the Master YHWH is on me, because YHWH has anointed me to preach good news to the humble. He has sent me to bind up the broken hearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and release to those who are bound... to proclaim the year of YHWH's favor.

ISAIAH 61:1-2; LUKE 4:18-19

The trumpet season is jubilee season. Release season. And Yahshua tied our own release directly to whether we release others.

- For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses. Matthew 6:14-15
- The servant forgiven an unpayable debt who would not release a small one, and was handed over to the tormentors. Matthew 18:21-35
- Whenever you stand praying, forgive, if you have anything against anyone. Mark 11:25

THE ORDER OF THINGS

Unforgiveness is a debt you are still choosing to collect on after the trumpet has announced that the debts are cancelled. It is standing in the middle of jubilee with somebody's account still open.

And underneath unforgiveness, every single time, is pride. Pride says I am owed. Pride says what they did is bigger than what I was forgiven. Humility is what lets the hand open.

That is why the trumpet comes before atonement on the calendar. The alarm sounds, and then there are days to go get your heart right. If you want a real Yom Teruah, do not just hear a horn. Go release somebody.

SECTION XII

The Watchman's Charge

There is one more role the trumpet belongs to, and it is not the King's. It is ours.

If, when he sees the sword come on the land, he blows the trumpet and warns the people, then whoever hears the sound of the trumpet and does not heed the warning, if the sword comes and takes him away, his blood will be on his own head... But if the watchman sees the sword come and does not blow the trumpet, and the people are not warned... I will require his blood at the watchman's hand.

EZEKIEL 33:2-6

- Cry aloud. Do not spare. Lift up your voice like a trumpet. Isaiah 58:1
- I will stand at my watch, and set myself on the ramparts, and will look out to see what he will say to me. Habakkuk 2:1
- Watch therefore, for you do not know when the lord of the house is coming, lest coming suddenly he might find you sleeping. What I tell you, I tell all: Watch. Mark 13:34-37

The watchman does not know the hour either. That was never his job. His job is to be awake and to have his lips on the horn.

SECTION XIII

The Day They Read the Book

One passage almost nobody connects to this feast, and it is one of the most beautiful in Scripture.

All the people gathered themselves together as one man into the wide place... and they spoke to Ezra the scribe to bring the book of the Torah of Moses... on the first day of the seventh month.

NEHEMIAH 8:1-3

That is Yom Teruah. They read from morning until midday. And when the people heard the instructions of YHWH after generations of exile, they wept. They realized how far they had drifted.

Go your way. Eat the fat, drink the sweet, and send portions to him for whom nothing is prepared, for this day is holy to our Master. Do not be grieved, for the joy of YHWH is your strength.

NEHEMIAH 8:10

That is what this day looks like when it is done right. The scattered people gather. The book is opened. Hearts break over what was lost. And then joy, feasting, and portions sent to whoever has nothing prepared.

Grieve over what was lost, then eat, then go feed somebody who has nothing. That is Yom Teruah.

SECTION XIV

How to Keep It

Straight from the text, with nothing added.

1. **A holy convocation.** Gather. Do not do this alone if you can help it. Leviticus 23:24; Hebrews 10:25
2. **A solemn rest.** No regular work. Lay the job down. Leviticus 23:24-25; Numbers 29:1

3. **Blow the trumpet.** A shofar if you have one, whatever horn you have if you do not. Make the sound. Leviticus 23:24; Numbers 10:10; Psalm 81:3
4. **Read the book out loud.** Follow the Nehemiah 8 pattern. Leviticus 23, Numbers 10, Matthew 24 and 25, 1 Thessalonians 4 and 5, 1 Corinthians 15.
5. **Search your heart and release your debts.** Forgive before Atonement comes. Matthew 6:14-15; Leviticus 25:9-10
6. **Eat well, and send a portion to someone who has nothing prepared.** Nehemiah 8:10

What is tradition, and what is Scripture

Be honest with people about this. The name Rosh Hashanah, the ten Days of Awe, apples and honey, the specific shofar sequences, the books of life and death ceremony, and the wedding customs sometimes taught alongside this day are all tradition. Some of it is beautiful. None of it is commanded.

The same honesty has to cut toward our own side of the aisle. A required crescent sighting is not commanded either, and neither is a calculated conjunction. Torah ties the month to the moon and leaves the method unwritten. Anyone who tells you their reckoning is the commanded one should be asked for the verse.

What is commanded is short: rest, gather, blow, and remember. Do not add a burden Scripture did not put there, and do not despise a brother who keeps a custom you do not. If one man marks the day by a sighted moon and another marks it by calculation, do not break fellowship over a sliver of light.

One man esteems one day as more important. Another esteems every day alike. Let each man be fully assured in his own mind. He who observes the day, observes it to the Master.

ROMANS 14:5-6

The point was never precision. The point is that you are watching.

SECTION XV

Bringing It Home

The whole study in one place:

- YHWH set appointments in the sky on day four of creation, before there was a single Hebrew on the earth.
- He called them his feasts, and commanded that they be kept in their appointed season.
- He put exactly one of them on the first day of a month, the head of the month, and made it a day of shouting. The only moed that is not counted from a date already fixed.
- Torah ties the month to the moon and does not hand us the mechanism, so we hold our reckoning with an open hand and do not call it a commandment.
- He fulfilled the first four appointments in Yahshua, precisely, on the day.
- Yahshua said he returns at a trumpet, after the tribulation, to gather his own and raise the dead.
- He said no one knows the day or the hour.

- And he said, in the same breath, that those who watch the tree will know the season, and that the day will not overtake the children of light like a thief.

So we do not set dates. We stay awake. We keep the appointment. We keep our lamps full. We keep our accounts released and our hands open. And when that broken, urgent, joyful sound goes up, we are not startled.

THE LAST WORD

We are the people who know the joyful sound (Psalm 89:15).

Blow the horn. Open the book. Forgive somebody. He is coming back at a trumpet, and he has never once missed an appointment.

SECTION XVI

Cross Reference Index

The command: Leviticus 23:23-25; Numbers 29:1-6

Moed, the appointed season: Genesis 1:14; Exodus 13:10; Leviticus 23:1-4; Psalm 104:19; Daniel 2:21; Acts 1:7; 1 Thessalonians 5:1-6

Miqra qodesh, the called assembly: Leviticus 23:2, 4, 24; Numbers 29:1

Teruah, the sound: Numbers 10:1-10; Joshua 6:5, 20; 1 Samuel 4:5; Ezra 3:11-13; Job 38:7; Psalm 47:5; Psalm 89:15

The head of the month: Genesis 1:14; Exodus 12:2; Numbers 10:10; Numbers 28:11; 1 Samuel 20:5, 18, 24-27; Psalm 81:3; Psalm 104:19; Colossians 2:16-17

Adding and taking away: Deuteronomy 4:2; Deuteronomy 12:32; Proverbs 30:5-6; Matthew 15:3-9; Mark 7:7-9

No one knows the day or hour: Matthew 24:36; Matthew 25:1-13; Mark 13:32-37; Revelation 3:3; Revelation 16:15

Knowing the season: Matthew 16:2-3; Matthew 24:32-33; Luke 12:54-56; Luke 19:44; Luke 21:29-31; 1 Thessalonians 5:1-6

The trumpet and the resurrection: Isaiah 27:13; Zechariah 9:14; Matthew 24:29-31; 1 Corinthians 15:51-52; 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17; Revelation 11:15

The Day of YHWH: Joel 2:1, 15; Amos 3:6; Zephaniah 1:14-16; Hosea 5:8; Exodus 19:16-19

Memorial and the books: Leviticus 23:24; Numbers 10:9; Malachi 3:16-18; Daniel 7:10; Revelation 20:12

The spring feasts fulfilled: 1 Corinthians 5:7; Acts 2:27; 1 Corinthians 15:20-23; Acts 2:1

Keeping the appointed times: Exodus 12:49; Numbers 15:15-16; Isaiah 56:3, 6-7; Isaiah 66:22-23; Ezekiel 45:21-25; Zechariah 14:16-19; Matthew 5:17-19; John 7:2, 10; John 14:15; Acts 18:21; Acts 20:16; Romans 11:17-24; 1 Corinthians 5:8; Ephesians 2:11-13, 19; 1 John 2:6

Relationship, not ritual: Isaiah 1:13-17; Amos 5:21-24; Micah 6:8; Matthew 15:8-9; Romans 14:5-6

Jubilee and forgiveness: Leviticus 25:8-10; Isaiah 61:1-2; Luke 4:18-19; Matthew 6:14-15; Matthew 18:21-35; Mark 11:25

The watchman: Isaiah 58:1; Ezekiel 33:2-7; Habakkuk 2:1; Mark 13:34-37

The gathering of the two houses: Isaiah 27:13; Ezekiel 37:15-22

The day they read the book: Nehemiah 8:1-12

Personal Notes and Convictions

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.